indigeneity makes decoloniality not just an ‘option’ but a civilisational imperative, which can no longer be delayed. However, I am in no position to universalise this argument as my vision in this regard is limited to Bharat.

Also, I recognise that decoloniality may not be the silver bullet to all of Bharat’s civilisational challenges, that it may not have all the answers to the questions that stare at Bharat’s indigenous consciousness; but it certainly has the potential to serve as a lens for Bharat to be better equipped to square up to its past and make sense of its own journey by applying its own frameworks instead of using frameworks that subtly or overtly exert an imperial colonialising influence.

One of the important premises of the preceding discussion is that Bharat is a ‘civilisation’ with an Indic consciousness whose agency was interfered with by European coloniality in ways that have resulted in the internalisation of the European worldview as the benchmark to be lived up to. Therefore, before I proceed to discuss the impact of European coloniality on Bharat’s consciousness, in the next chapter I will attempt to make good the assumption that Bharat was and remains a civilisation, at least at the level of the society, which has implications for formulation of policies and lawmaking. This can offer clarity on what makes a society a civilisation and why Bharat must be treated as one, so as to better understand (*a*) the true impact of the European coloniser’s nation-state project on Bharat and (b) whether Bharat’s journey towards constitutionalism reflects its self-understanding as a civilisation.